

and player models are beautifully rendered, and certain areas of the maps are extremely colourful. There is a detailed quality look to the game that is normally seen more in action FPS games than in MMORPGs.

The game is targeted at men, and the ample bosoms for all female characters is proof enough. Despite the high-detail graphics, the game plays well even over slower Net connections, and this was perhaps the major reason the game became so popular.

You can choose to play as either a dwarf, human, dark elf, necromancer or troll. As with all RPGs, you need to complete a few missions and gain experience points to make you better equipped to handle the world you're thrust into. As you pass levels, you get stronger and more experienced, and even after a couple of months of playing, you'll still be able to learn a few things and buy better weapons.

The game is tough at first, but if you make the right friends, you can last a lot longer. The game needs co-operative play in order to get anywhere, and if you don't form your own little clan, you'll soon meet a group of monsters that don't like the look of you and will crush you. Though you will spawn again, it's very irritating to have to find your own body and reclaim all your belongings from it. You also lose experience each time you perish.

Final Fantasy XI

This game has wonderful graphics, but is simply not playable on slower connections. Instead of races, *Final Fantasy* uses "jobs" to distinguish between player types—warrior, black or white mage, monk, and so on.

The game is typical MMORPG, and you need to gain experience and skills in your chosen field by playing more and more. In order to survive here you need to form groups, just as in most MMORPGs. The same rule of patience when playing MMORPGs applies here as well: you'll no doubt have a very rocky start and die often before